

Practical - (4)

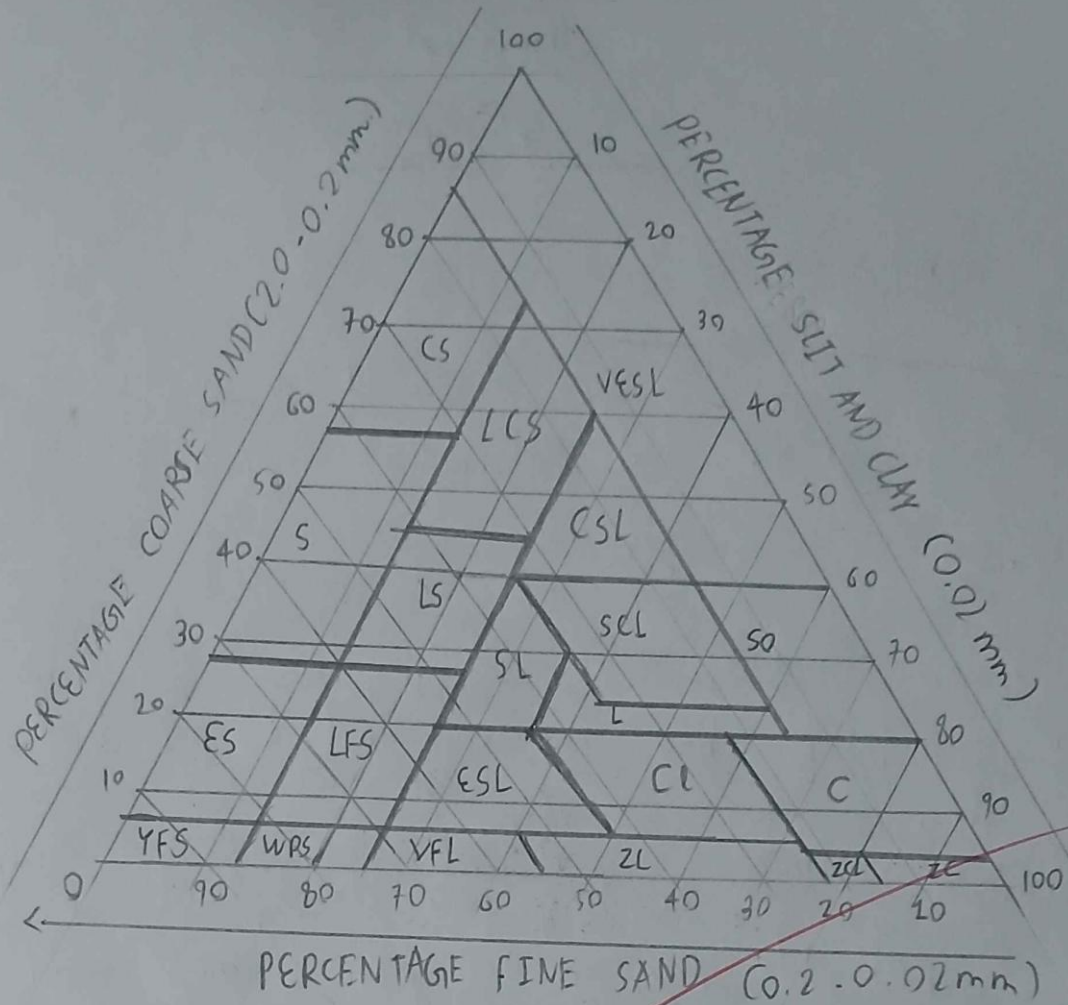
Soil quality and Soil texture

Soil quality

- It is the capacity of a soil to function within the boundaries of ecosystem to sustain biological productivity, maintain environmental quality and promote plant and animal health.
- It encompasses its capacity for (i) crop productivity (ii) food safety and (iii) health of animals and humans.
- It can improve or deteriorate depending on the influencing factors such as humus content, phosphorus status, degree of saturation etc.

Soil texture

- It is a measure of the size of soil's individual mineral particles and the proportion of different size particles.
 - Clay particles do not exceed 0.002 mm in diameter.
 - Silt particles range between 0.002 and 0.05 mm in diameter.
 - Sand particles range between 1.0 and 2.0 mm in diameter.
 - Based on the proportion of clay, silt and sand particles, soils are divided into four texture classes
- (1) Sandy soils have a large proportion of sand particles.
 - (2) Loams are soils with approximately equal proportion of sand, silt and clay particles.
 - (3) Clay soils have high proportion of clay particles.
 - (4) Loam soils have a crumbly, spongy quality that allows proper water drainage and air circulation, these generally are considered good agricultural soil.



TRIANGLE SYSTEM

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